Artisan Mid Cap Fund

QUARTERLY
Commentary

Investor Class: ARTMX | Advisor Class: APDMX | Institutional Class: APHMX

As of 30 September 2026

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Investing Environment

Global equities reached new highs in Q3 2026, although the advance came in fits and starts and masked significant dispersion beneath the surface as markets grappled with rising rates, elevated oil prices amid continued conflict in the Middle East and renewed US-Canada trade tensions.

Bonds were squarely in focus throughout the quarter as developed economies faced rising borrowing costs, large fiscal deficits and a more hawkish turn in monetary policy. Speaking in August at the Federal Reserve's annual symposium in Jackson Hole, Wyoming, Chair Kevin Warsh emphasized that inflation remained too high even as economic activity strengthened, raising expectations for a rate hike. The Fed followed through with a 25bps increase at its September meeting, its first hike since 2023. Outside the US, the European Central Bank, the Bank of Japan, the Reserve Bank of Australia and Norges Bank also raised rates, while the Bank of England and the Bank of Canada held policy rates steady. Long-term yields continued to rise, with the 30-year Treasury yield reaching its highest level since 2002. Fiscal concerns also remained in focus as US federal debt crossed $40 trillion for the first time, while government borrowing costs for several other developed markets reached multiyear highs.

Despite tighter financial conditions, US economic data remained resilient. Q2 real GDP growth was revised meaningfully higher to 2.2%, while Q3 estimates at quarter-end were around 3.7%. Consumer spending remained healthy, rising 0.9% in August, and recent PMI readings continued to signal expansion. At the same time, the labor market showed signs of gradual cooling and consumer confidence fell sharply in September.

In the US, large-cap stocks were relatively resilient, while returns deteriorated further down the cap spectrum. Value outperformed growth across market cap tiers, with the divergence particularly pronounced among smaller companies. Notably, the S&P 500® Equal Weight Index underperformed the cap-weighted S&P 500® Index by 4.5 percentage points, with September marking the largest monthly gap since March 2020. Sector leadership was similarly uneven: Energy posted double-digit gains across nearly every major index as oil prices crossed $100 per barrel, while industrials broadly declined. Within the Russell Midcap® Growth Index, dispersion was particularly pronounced, with the highest returning sector (energy) outperforming the lowest (industrials) by nearly 34 percentage points. Health care also performed well, while information technology (IT) advanced despite rising rates, supported by continued AI enthusiasm and strength in mega-caps. Outside the US, international stocks generally held up well, although small caps also declined and emerging markets drifted lower after a terrific run during the first half of the year.

AI continued to be a central theme, although market leadership shifted during Q3. After extraordinary gains in the first half of the year, semiconductor and other AI infrastructure stocks pulled back sharply as investors more closely scrutinized the pace, duration and financing of AI spending, as well as the returns on that spending. Yet the weakness was not uniform across the AI ecosystem: The Magnificent Seven gained roughly 11% during the quarter, helping to support large-cap indices even as value generally outperformed growth elsewhere in the market. Hyperscaler investment remained robust, with debt and other external financing playing a growing role in the buildout amid higher borrowing costs. Additional crosscurrents also contributed to greater dispersion across the AI ecosystem, including data center construction and power constraints, intensifying competition among model providers and efficiency improvements that could reduce the hardware intensity of certain workloads.

Exhibit 1: Index Returns (Local Currency)

	Q3 2026
Russell 1000® Index	1.8%
Russell 1000® Growth Index	0.9%
Russell 1000® Value Index	2.6%
Russell Midcap® Index	-3.0%
Russell Midcap® Growth Index	-5.8%
Russell Midcap® Value Index	-2.0%
Russell 2000® Index	-7.2%
Russell 2000® Growth Index	-9.4%
Russell 2000® Value Index	-4.9%
MSCI EAFE Index	0.7%
MSCI AC World Small Mid Cap Index	-2.4%
MSCI EM Index	-2.8%
MSCI ACWI	1.3%

Source: Artisan Partners/FactSet/MSCI/Russell. As of 30 Sep 2026. **Past performance does not guarantee and is not a reliable indicator of future results.** An investment cannot be made directly in an index.

Performance Discussion

The portfolio generated a negative absolute return but outpaced the Russell Midcap® Growth Index, which declined nearly 6% amid a more challenging market environment for growth equities. Size was also a significant headwind, with the largest market cap quintile within the index outperforming the smallest by more than 23%. Despite a more difficult environment for active mid-cap growth managers, the portfolio outperformed the index by nearly 2% during the quarter, ranking in the 27th percentile of its Lipper mid-cap growth peer group for the 1-year period*.

Strong security selection in communication services and our overweight to health care were the largest contributors to relative performance. IT was the largest relative detractor, reflecting both weaker security selection and our underweight to the sector. Our underweight to energy also detracted as the sector posted a double-digit gain.

In communication services, portfolio holdings declined 1.9% while companies within the index fell nearly 15%, with relative results benefiting from strength in Spotify and Fox. Spotify delivered solid quarterly results, while Fox shares benefited from the announced acquisition of Roku.

Within IT, data infrastructure software companies such as Snowflake performed well as investors increasingly recognized their potential to benefit from rising AI investment and adoption. Although we built Snowflake to a Crop℠ position during the quarter, our below-benchmark position in the stock made it the largest individual detractor from relative performance. Several semiconductor and AI infrastructure-related holdings also pulled back following strong performances earlier in the year.

Our health care overweight was the largest positive contributor to relative performance, supported by overweight positions in life sciences tools and services and biotechnology. Within the sector, Twist Bioscience, Argenx, Waters and West Pharma were among our stronger performers, partially offset by weakness in Veracyte and Ascendis Pharma. Industrials also contributed to relative results, reflecting strong stock selection in a quarter where the sector declined by over 20% within the benchmark.

Among our top contributors in Q3 were Twist Bioscience, Cloudflare and Robinhood. Twist Bioscience is a life sciences company that leverages a proprietary silicon-based DNA writing platform across drug discovery, diagnostics and other applications. Revenue grew 23% year over year, exceeding expectations, driven by strength in DNA synthesis and protein solutions. Twist is also gaining traction in AI-enabled drug discovery, serving as an integrated lab partner for Amazon Bio Discovery and as an independent evaluator of Anthropic's AI-designed protein binders. We believe these developments reinforce the company's strong position in next-generation pharmaceutical research. We trimmed the position following strong share-price appreciation.

Cloudflare operates a global cloud network providing security, performance and developer services to businesses. Its integrated platform allows the company to layer additional services onto its network as customer needs evolve. The company delivered a strong quarter, with revenue growth accelerating to 36% year over year and continued momentum across large customers. Traction in Cloudflare Workers, its serverless developer platform, also appears to be driving incremental demand for its security products, reinforcing the benefits of Cloudflare's integrated platform. We expect the company to benefit from growing demand for cybersecurity and AI-enabled applications.

Robinhood Markets operates a financial services platform offering brokerage, cash management and other investment products. Recent results exceeded expectations, with a record $22 billion of net new deposits and continued strong revenue growth. The company is also expanding across credit, prediction markets, banking and crypto, creating opportunities to deepen customer relationships and increase monetization. We expect Robinhood to continue gaining share in the retail wealth market as its predominantly younger customer base matures and accumulates assets. We added to the position during the recent pullback.

Among our biggest detractors in Q3 were RBC Bearings, Veracyte and Lattice Semiconductor. RBC Bearings is a leading provider of specialty bearings, gearing and motion control products, with over 70% of revenue derived from sole- or primary-sourced components. Recent quarterly results exceeded expectations, with commercial aerospace growth accelerating to 20% and broad-based strength across industrial markets. The company also raised its margin outlook and expects defense growth to reaccelerate as capacity constraints ease. Despite the strong results, shares declined amid broader weakness in aerospace and defense stocks. We believe RBC has a multi-year growth runway across aerospace, defense and industrial markets, and we added to the position following the pullback.

Veracyte is a molecular diagnostics company offering genomic tests that help physicians make more informed treatment decisions and reduce unnecessary procedures. Recent results were mixed, with continued strength in its Afirma® test for thyroid cancer offset by a modest shortfall in its Decipher® test for prostate cancer following treatment guideline changes for low-risk patients. We see Veracyte as well positioned to benefit from expanding adoption of precision oncology, with its Prosigna® test for breast cancer representing a potential new growth driver. We trimmed the position as questions around growth of the Decipher® test are likely to persist until newer products become more meaningful contributors.

Lattice is a fabless leader in low-power field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs). Quarterly results were strong, with FPGA revenue growing 62% year over year on strong demand across data center, communications and industrial markets. However, an investor rotation away from data center hardware enablers weighed on the stock. The AMI acquisition adds platform firmware and data center management software to Lattice's FPGA portfolio, creating a more complete management and control platform for AI data center infrastructure and expanding its addressable market. We expect the acquisition to accelerate Lattice's profit cycle, and we added to the position following the pullback.

Portfolio Activity

During the quarter, we initiated new positions in Manhattan Associates, Okta and Clean Harbors. Manhattan Associates is a leading provider of supply chain and warehouse management software that helps customers optimize the movement of goods through increasingly complex distribution networks. We initiated a Garden℠ position and later elevated it to a Crop℠ as our conviction increased. We believe Manhattan is among the more advanced software providers in deploying agentic AI, with early adoption demonstrating meaningful customer savings and an emerging monetization opportunity. Continued cloud migration and expansion beyond its traditional retail customer base into industrial and logistics markets should further broaden the company's long-term growth opportunity.

Okta provides identity and access management software that helps organizations securely manage users, applications and devices. We initiated a Garden℠ position as the core business began to reaccelerate, supported by stronger growth with large-enterprise customers, broader adoption of Okta Identity Governance and improved sales productivity. We also see an emerging opportunity in securing AI agents as enterprises deploy them across increasingly complex environments. While monetization remains early, agentic security is already helping pull forward broader identity and security modernization, and we expect it could develop into an additional growth driver over time.

Clean Harbors is a leading provider of environmental and hazardous waste management services, with a vertically integrated network spanning collection, treatment, incineration and disposal. We initiated a Garden℠ position as we believe the company is relatively early in a profit cycle supported by recovering industrial activity and several secular growth opportunities. Reshoring is driving demand from new manufacturing facilities, while stricter requirements for the remediation and disposal of PFAS, a group of synthetic chemicals that can persist in the environment, are creating a meaningful opportunity for the company's difficult-to-replicate hazardous waste infrastructure. We also see longer-term potential in its emerging data center solutions business, while high incremental margins should provide earnings leverage as volumes accelerate.

In addition to Lattice Semiconductor and Robinhood, we added to Compass and Twilio. Compass is a residential real estate brokerage that uses an integrated technology platform to enhance agent productivity and client engagement. Recent results exceeded expectations, with pro forma revenue growing 14% year over year as the company continued to gain share despite a challenging housing environment. Management also raised its cost synergy target from its post-acquisition integration of Anywhere Real Estate as it continues to integrate its technology across the combined agent base. We expect Compass to benefit from an eventual housing recovery, while its increased scale, technology platform and growing inventory of exclusive and coming-soon listings provide additional company-specific growth opportunities. We initiated a Garden℠ position late last quarter and added to it on the pullback.

Twilio is a leading communications platform that enables businesses and developers to integrate voice, messaging, email and other capabilities into their applications. Recent results exceeded expectations, with organic revenue growing 17% year over year and continued strength across voice, messaging and higher-margin software products. We believe rising adoption of voice AI should increase demand for Twilio's communications infrastructure while creating opportunities to layer higher-value software onto its platform. Improving multi-product adoption and continued cost discipline also support an attractive long-term margin opportunity. We added to our Garden℠ position during the pullback.

We ended our investment campaign in Monolithic Power Systems, FTAI Aviation and Ionis Pharmaceuticals during the quarter. Monolithic Power Systems designs analog power-management semiconductors used across data center, communications and industrial applications. The company delivered another strong quarter, supported by growing demand across AI data centers, including compute, optical networking and other rack infrastructure. However, as data center power architectures evolve toward 800-volt direct current, we see greater uncertainty around Monolithic's longer-term market share amid increased

competition and its lack of captive silicon carbide and gallium nitride supply. We exited the position to consolidate our AI infrastructure exposure into higher-conviction opportunities.

FTAI Aviation owns and maintains commercial jet engines, with a focus on the maintenance, repair and exchange of CFM56 and V2500 engines. We exited the position as a weaker quarter and increased uncertainty around the timing and scale of its FTAI Power opportunity reduced our conviction. Higher oil prices also increased the risk that accelerated aircraft retirements could weigh on the aerospace aftermarket. While FTAI Power remains a potentially attractive long-term opportunity, we believe the path to realizing that value is likely to remain uneven, and we consolidated our aerospace exposure into higher-conviction holdings such as RBC.

Ionis Pharmaceuticals is a biotechnology company specializing in RNA-targeted therapies for patients with significant unmet medical needs. The company is transitioning toward commercializing more of its own medicines, allowing it to capture greater value from its innovation. However, following disappointing clinical results for eplontersen and pelacarsen, we exited our small Garden[SM] position as several important pipeline catalysts have either been unsuccessful or shifted further out, reducing the potential for near-term upside.

In addition to Twist Bioscience and Veracyte, notable trims included Viking Holdings and US Foods. Viking is a leading operator in river and luxury ocean cruising, with a business model built around affluent US travelers. Unlike peers, Viking emphasizes destination-focused itineraries over onboard amenities, supporting higher profitability. Recent results were solid, with strong demand and pricing, and 2027 bookings running ahead of the prior year. However, unusually low water levels on some major European rivers resulted in cancellations and additional costs, creating near-term uncertainty. Following strong share-price appreciation, we moved to Harvest[SM] the position based on our valuation framework.

US Foods is the second-largest food distributor in the US, serving independent restaurants, national chains, health care providers and hospitality venues. Recent results improved, with EBITDA growing 10% and margins expanding as the company continued to execute on its self-help initiatives. Independent restaurant volume growth accelerated to 5%, supported by strong new account activity. While we continue to see long-term value in the business, we reduced the position following the recent rally as valuation became less compelling and near-term catalysts appeared more limited.

Perspective

US economic activity remains relatively strong, but rising interest rates and commodity prices present increasing challenges for markets. Given ongoing tensions in the Middle East, global trade disputes and persistent budget deficits, these pressures could remain elevated. We are incorporating these risks into our valuation framework and continue to favor companies with identifiable, company-specific profit cycles over those more dependent on an improving macroeconomic environment.

AI remains an important market driver, with tremendous momentum and innovation across the AI ecosystem. At the same time, we believe a growing number of factors warrant greater selectivity, including data center construction and permitting challenges, power constraints, intensifying competition among frontier model providers and the emergence of lower-cost open-source models. More of the AI buildout is also being funded with debt, while memory optimization techniques and other innovations may reduce the hardware intensity of certain workloads. The ultimate impact is difficult to predict, reinforcing our belief in the importance of selectivity within the trend. We maintain meaningful exposure to AI infrastructure enablers, though we modestly reduced that exposure during the quarter. Our investments are increasingly concentrated in our highest-conviction franchises, including Lattice Semiconductor, Comfort Systems, Entegris and SiTime, where we believe differentiated intellectual property, market positioning and identifiable profit cycles should support attractive long-term opportunities as infrastructure architectures evolve.

At the same time, some of the strongest AI-related performance of late has come from infrastructure and security software companies such as Cloudflare and Snowflake, where there is growing evidence that AI adoption is accelerating demand for their services. We have exposure to this area while remaining mindful of the aggressive valuation assumptions reflected in many of these stocks. Elsewhere, we are becoming more confident that well-positioned vertical software franchises can incorporate AI in ways that are accretive to their businesses over time. Valuations in this area remain more attractive than among faster-growing AI infrastructure companies, and we have begun to modestly increase exposure through companies such as Manhattan Associates and Tyler Technologies.

After strong year-to-date performance, aerospace stocks cooled during the quarter amid some of the macro pressures discussed above. While those factors can influence near-term results, we continue to see compelling company-specific profit cycles in the sector. New engine and aircraft platforms are creating opportunities for significantly higher content per platform for well-positioned suppliers such as Woodward and RBC Bearings, supporting long-term growth potential that is less dependent on the broader economic environment. We used lower valuations during the quarter to modestly add where our conviction in the underlying profit cycle remains intact.

Health care performed relatively well during the quarter and has been a source of strength for the portfolio year to date. While health care traditionally has less cyclical exposure than other sectors, rising rates can pressure valuations for long-duration growth stocks. We continue to believe, however, that the unique profit cycles driving many of our health care holdings remain compelling enough to overcome a rising-rate environment. We saw evidence of this during the quarter from Twist Bioscience, but also from Argenx, which reported positive Phase 3 trial results for VYVGART® in autoimmune myositis, and West Pharmaceutical, which continues to see strong demand for its value-added biologic drug containment solutions. Waters also reported strong organic growth

across its life sciences instruments and consumables business while demonstrating solid progress in the integration of its recently acquired BD Life Sciences business.

More broadly, we remain focused on finding idiosyncratic profit cycles rather than relying on a particular macroeconomic outcome. In an environment where interest rates, commodity prices and AI-related expectations are creating greater dispersion, we believe company-specific earnings drivers, valuation discipline and selective exposure to durable secular trends remain especially important. As always, we will continue to follow our process and look to take advantage of volatility when it creates attractive long-term opportunities.

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Investment Results (%)

As of 30 September 2026	QTD	YTD	Average Annual Total Returns 1 Yr	3 Yr	5 Yr	10 Yr	Inception
Investor Class: ARTMX—Inception: 27 Jun 1997	**-4.16**	**6.29**	**5.83**	**14.13**	**1.21**	**11.12**	**12.51**
Advisor Class: APDMX—Inception: 1 Apr 2015	**-4.14**	**6.37**	**5.97**	**14.28**	**1.35**	**11.28**	**12.57**
Institutional Class: APHMX—Inception: 1 Jul 2000	**-4.15**	**6.43**	**6.05**	**14.39**	**1.44**	**11.37**	**12.75**
Russell Midcap® Growth Index	-5.84	1.01	-2.73	15.36	4.92	11.86	9.28
Russell Midcap® Index	-3.00	11.84	12.02	17.20	8.04	11.17	10.07

Source: Artisan Partners/Russell. Returns for periods less than one year are not annualized. For the period prior to inception, each of Advisor Class and Institutional Class's performance is the Investor Class's return for that period ("Linked Performance"). Linked Performance has not been restated to reflect expenses of the Advisor or Institutional Class and each share's respective returns during that period would be different if such expenses were reflected.

Past performance does not guarantee and is not a reliable indicator of future results. Investment returns and principal values will fluctuate so that an investor's shares, when redeemed, may be worth more or less than their original cost. Current performance may be lower or higher than that shown. Call 800.344.1770 for current to most recent month-end performance.

Expense Ratios (%)*

	ARTMX	APDMX	APHMX
Semi-Annual Report	1.23/—	1.10/—	0.99/—
Prospectus	1.21/—	1.07/—	0.98/—

*Unsubsidized/subsidized. Semi-annual Report: 31 Mar 2026. Prospectus: 30 Sep 2025. See prospectus for further details. Semi-Annual Report Figures: Unaudited, annualized for the six-month period.

Top 10 Holdings (% of total portfolio)

Argenx SE	4.8
West Pharmaceutical Services Inc	4.2
Lattice Semiconductor Corp	4.1
Comfort Systems USA Inc	3.2
Ascendis Pharma A/S	3.0
RBC Bearings Inc	2.9
Twist Bioscience Corp	2.9
Spotify Technology SA	2.8
Woodward Inc	2.6
Insmed Inc	2.5
Total	**33.1%**

Carefully consider the Fund's investment objective, risks and charges and expenses. This and other important information is contained in the Fund's prospectus and summary prospectus, which can be obtained by calling 800.344.1770. Read carefully before investing.

Current and future portfolio holdings are subject to risk. The value of portfolio securities selected by the investment team may rise or fall in response to company, market, economic, political, regulatory or other news, at times greater than the market or benchmark index. A portfolio's governance and other material sustainability considerations may limit the investment opportunities available and, as a result, the portfolio may forgo certain investment opportunities and underperform portfolios that do not consider these sustainability factors. International investments involve special risks, including currency fluctuation, lower liquidity, different accounting methods and economic and political systems, and higher transaction costs. These risks typically are greater in emerging and less developed markets, including frontier markets. Securities of small- and medium-sized companies tend to have a shorter history of operations, be more volatile and less liquid and may have underperformed securities of large companies during some periods. Growth securities may underperform other asset types during a given period.

Russell Midcap® Growth Index measures the performance of US mid-cap companies with higher price/book ratios and forecasted growth values. **Russell Midcap® Index** measures the performance of roughly 800 US mid-cap companies. **Russell Midcap® Value Index** measures the performance of US mid-cap companies with lower price/book ratios and forecasted growth values. **Russell 2000® Index** measures the performance of roughly 2,000 US small-cap companies. **Russell 1000® Growth Index** measures the performance of US large-cap companies with higher price/book ratios and forecasted growth values. **Russell 1000® Value Index** measures the performance of US large-cap companies with lower price/book ratios and forecasted growth values. **Russell 1000® Index** measures the performance of roughly 1,000 US large-cap companies. **MSCI Emerging Markets Index** measures the performance of emerging markets. **MSCI All Country World Small Mid Index** measures the performance of small- and mid-cap companies in developed and emerging markets. **Russell 2000® Growth Index** measures the performance of US small-cap companies with higher price/book ratios and forecasted growth values. **MSCI EAFE Index** measures the performance of developed markets, excluding the US and Canada. **Russell 2000® Value Index** measures the performance of US small-cap companies with lower price/book ratios and forecasted growth values. **MSCI All Country World Index** measures the performance of developed and emerging markets. **S&P 500® Index** measures the performance of 500 US companies focused on the large-cap sector of the market. **S&P 500® Equal Weighted Index** gives each constituent the same weight in the index, versus the market weighted index where bigger companies hold a larger share of the index. The index(es) are unmanaged; include net reinvested dividends; do not reflect fees or expenses; and are not available for direct investment.

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***Lipper rankings are based on total return of a fund's stated share class, are historical and do not represent future results.** As of 30 Sep 2026 Artisan Mid Cap Fund (ARTMX) ranked 27th percentile out of 316 funds for the 1YR period, 65th percentile out of 302 funds for the 5YR period, 36th percentile out of 255 funds for the 10YR period and 2nd percentile out of 52 funds for the inception-to-date period in the Lipper Mid-Cap Growth category. The number of funds in the category may include several share classes of the same mutual fund which may have a material impact on the fund's ranking within the category.

Governance and other material sustainability assessments represent one of many pieces of research available and the degree to which it impacts holdings may vary based on manager discretion.

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Contribution to Return (CTR) represents the contribution of an investment to the total portfolio return. CTR is calculated by multiplying a security's portfolio weight by its in-portfolio return daily for the period and has been derived from a holdings-based methodology, which uses daily positions and pricing rather than intraday transactions. **Attribution** quantifies the relationship between a portfolio's relative returns and the active management decisions differentiating the portfolio from the benchmark. **CTR and Attribution** are not exact, nor representative of actual investor returns due to several variables (e.g., fees, expenses, transactions) and therefore should be considered an approximation and examined in conjunction with the performance of the portfolio during the period. If applicable, securities of the same issuer are aggregated and may be delta-adjusted to determine the weight in the portfolio, and aggregation of corporate affiliates is subject to the determination of Artisan Partners. Further information on the methodology used is available upon request.

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Earnings Momentum is a factor that is measured in terms of changes in consensus earnings estimates for the next 12 months over the most recent quarter and using the most recent quarterly earnings surprise. **Organic Growth** is the revenue and earnings growth a company achieves as a result of its own operations and resources rather than those attributable to mergers and acquisitions. **Accretive** refers to an investment's gradual contribution to earnings growth or share valuation. **Earnings Before Interest, Taxes, Depreciation and Amortization (EBITDA)** is an indicator of a company's financial performance which is calculated by looking at earnings before the deduction of interest expenses, taxes, depreciation and amortization.

Our capital allocation process is designed to build position size according to our conviction. Portfolio holdings develop through three stages: Garden℠, Crop℠ and Harvest℠. Garden℠ investments are situations where we believe we are right, but there is not clear evidence that the profit cycle has taken hold, so positions are small. Crop℠ investments are holdings where we have gained conviction in the company's profit cycle, so positions are larger. Harvest℠ investments are holdings that have exceeded our estimate of intrinsic value or holdings where there is a deceleration in the company's profit cycle. Harvest℠ investments are generally being reduced or sold from the portfolios.

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